Lesson 1: Adding Integers

An integer is a whole number that can be positive, negative, or zero. When adding two integers with the same sign, add their absolute values and keep the common sign. For example, (-3) + (-6) = -9.

When adding integers with different signs, subtract the smaller absolute value from the larger absolute value, then keep the sign of the integer with the larger absolute value. For example, (-8) + 13 = 5 because 13 is farther from zero than -8.

Example 1

A diver is at -12 meters and rises 7 meters. Her new position is -12 + 7 = -5 meters, because the number line moves 7 units to the right.

Activity 1: Try it

Problem A: Compute (-4) + (-9). Problem B: Compute 15 + (-6). Problem C: A temperature of -3 degrees drops 5 degrees. What is the new temperature?

Answer Key

Problem A: -13. Problem B: 9. Problem C: -8 degrees.